

NEXORA TECHNOLOGIES INC.

Employee Policy Handbook

This is a fictional, synthetic document created for a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) practice project. Nexora Technologies Inc. is not a real company. All names, employee IDs, salaries, ID numbers, addresses, and contact details contained in this document are randomly generated and do not correspond to any real person.

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Owner: People & Culture Department

1. Introduction & Company Overview

Nexora Technologies Inc. ("Nexora," "the Company," "we," or "us") is a software and cloud-services company headquartered in Austin, Texas, with regional offices in Lahore, Pakistan and Berlin, Germany. Nexora employs approximately 640 people across engineering, sales, customer success, finance, and operations functions.

This Employee Policy Handbook (the "Handbook") establishes the rules, standards, and expectations that govern the employment relationship between Nexora and its employees, contractors, and interns. It applies to all personnel regardless of location, employment level, or department, unless a specific local addendum states otherwise.

This Handbook does not constitute an employment contract and does not guarantee continued employment for any specific duration. Nexora reserves the right to amend, suspend, or replace any policy in this Handbook at its sole discretion, with notice provided to employees through the internal HR portal.

1.1 Governing Principles

All policies in this Handbook are built around five governing principles: integrity, confidentiality, fairness, accountability, and safety. Employees are expected to internalize these principles and apply them even in situations not explicitly covered by written policy.

2. Code of Conduct

Employees are expected to act professionally, honestly, and respectfully in all interactions with colleagues, clients, vendors, and members of the public. The following subsections describe specific behavioral standards.

2.1 Anti-Harassment and Non-Discrimination

Nexora prohibits discrimination or harassment on the basis of race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, national origin, age, disability, marital status, or any other characteristic protected by applicable law. Any employee who experiences or witnesses harassment should report it immediately to their manager, the People & Culture Department, or through the anonymous Ethics Hotline at ethics-hotline@nexora-example.com.

2.2 Conflicts of Interest

Employees must disclose any outside employment, financial interest, or personal relationship that could reasonably be seen to conflict with Nexora's interests. Disclosure forms are submitted through the HR portal and reviewed by the employee's department head and the Compliance Officer.

2.3 Gifts and Business Courtesies

Employees may not accept gifts, hospitality, or favors from vendors or clients that exceed \$75 USD in value, or that could be reasonably interpreted as an attempt to influence a business decision. Any gift valued above this threshold must be reported to the Compliance Officer and, in most cases, declined or surrendered to the Company.

2.4 Substance-Free Workplace

Nexora maintains a substance-free workplace. Employees may not be under the influence of illegal drugs or alcohol during working hours, except at Company-sanctioned social events where alcohol is served responsibly and in moderation.

3. Data Privacy & Confidentiality Policy

Nexora collects and processes personal data belonging to employees, customers, and business partners. This section describes how such data must be handled, and it is the most frequently referenced section during compliance audits.

3.1 Categories of Protected Data

Protected data at Nexora is classified into three tiers: **Public** (marketing materials, job postings), **Internal** (org charts, internal memos, non-sensitive project plans), and **Restricted** (Social Security Numbers, national ID numbers, bank account details, medical records, salary information, performance reviews, and background check results). Restricted data must never be shared over unencrypted channels such as personal email or unencrypted chat.

3.2 Employee Personal Data Handling

Personal data collected from employees during onboarding — including full legal name, date of birth, national identification or Social Security Number, home address, banking details for payroll, and emergency contact information — is stored exclusively in the HR Information System (HRIS) operated by the People & Culture Department. Access to this data is restricted to HR personnel, the employee's direct manager (limited fields only), and Payroll. Any request to export employee Restricted data must be approved in writing by the Chief People Officer.

3.3 Data Retention

Employee personnel files, including Restricted data, are retained for seven (7) years following termination of employment, after which they are securely destroyed in accordance with applicable labor and tax record-keeping laws. Background check results are retained for a maximum of two (2) years post-hire unless required otherwise by law.

3.4 Data Breach Reporting

Any suspected exposure or loss of Restricted data must be reported to the Security Incident Response Team within one (1) hour of discovery via security-incidents@nexora-example.com or the 24/7 hotline. Failure to report a known breach in a timely manner is grounds for disciplinary action up to and including termination.

4. Compensation & Benefits Policy

Compensation at Nexora is structured into salary bands aligned to role level and geographic location. The table below summarizes the current annual base salary bands (in USD) for the Engineering and Customer Success functions, effective the current fiscal year.

Level	Title	Band (Austin, TX)	Band (Lahore, PK)	Band (Berlin, DE)
L1	Associate Engineer	\$72,000 – \$88,000	\$18,000 – \$24,000	€48,000 – €58,000
L2	Software Engineer	\$95,000 – \$118,000	\$26,000 – \$34,000	€62,000 – €75,000
L3	Senior Engineer	\$128,000 – \$155,000	\$38,000 – \$48,000	€82,000 – €98,000
L4	Staff Engineer	\$162,000 – \$195,000	\$52,000 – \$64,000	€105,000 – €125,000

L2	Customer Success Rep	\$58,000 – \$70,000	\$16,000 – \$21,000	€40,000 – €48,000
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4.1 Bonus and Equity

Eligible employees at L2 and above participate in an annual performance bonus program, targeted at 8-20% of base salary depending on level. L3 and above employees are additionally eligible for restricted stock unit (RSU) grants vesting over four years with a one-year cliff.

4.2 Health and Insurance Benefits

Nexora provides medical, dental, and vision insurance to all full-time employees starting on day one of employment, with the Company covering 90% of the employee premium and 70% of dependent premiums. Employees enrolled in benefits must submit dependent Social Security Numbers or national ID equivalents to the benefits administrator for coverage verification purposes.

5. Leave & Attendance Policy

Nexora offers a flexible time-off (FTO) program for exempt employees and an accrual-based system for non-exempt employees, described below.

5.1 Flexible Time Off (Exempt Employees)

Exempt employees may take time off as needed, subject to manager approval and business needs, without a fixed annual cap. Employees are expected to take a minimum of 15 days off per calendar year to maintain wellbeing.

5.2 Accrual-Based PTO (Non-Exempt Employees)

Non-exempt employees accrue 1.25 days of paid time off per month worked (15 days annually), up to a maximum carryover of 10 unused days into the following calendar year.

5.3 Parental Leave

Nexora provides 16 weeks of fully paid parental leave to the primary caregiver and 8 weeks to the secondary caregiver, for births, adoptions, or foster placements, regardless of gender.

5.4 Sick Leave and Medical Documentation

Employees absent for more than three (3) consecutive working days due to illness must submit a medical certificate to HR. Medical certificates and any related health information are treated as Restricted data under Section 3 and stored separately from the general personnel file.

6. Disciplinary Policy

Nexora follows a progressive discipline model consisting of four stages: verbal warning, written warning, final written warning, and termination. Serious violations — including data breaches of Restricted information, harassment, fraud, or safety violations — may result in immediate termination without progressing through earlier stages.

All disciplinary actions are documented in the employee's confidential HR file and require sign-off from both the employee's manager and a People & Culture Business Partner.

Appendix A: Sample Employee Records (Restricted — HR Use Only)

The table below is a synthetic excerpt of the HRIS employee master table, included in this document to simulate Restricted-tier data for retrieval and access-control testing purposes. **All individuals, ID numbers, and figures below are fictional.**

Emp ID	Name	Role	Dept	Nat'l ID (fictional)	DOB	Base Salary	Emergency Contact
NX-1042	Amelia J. Ferro	Senior Engineer	Engineering	482-11-7734	1990-03-14	\$142,000	David Ferro, +1-512-555-0148
NX-1078	Rohan K. Batra	Product Manager	Product	556-90-2201	1988-11-02	\$151,500	Neha Batra, +1-512-555-0199
NX-1103	Sana T. Qureshi	Customer Success Lead	CS	331-27-5588	1994-07-21	\$76,200	Imran Qureshi, +92-300-555-0177
NX-1156	Marcus O. Lindqvist	Staff Engineer	Engineering	719-44-9012	1985-01-30	\$188,000	Elin Lindqvist, +49-30-555-0122
NX-1201	Grace N. Owusu	Finance Analyst	Finance	204-63-1187	1996-09-09	\$81,400	Kofi Owusu, +1-512-555-0163
NX-1234	Daniyal F. Sheikh	DevOps Engineer	Engineering	890-15-3346	1992-05-18	\$118,700	Farah Sheikh, +92-321-555-0190

Access to this appendix is limited to HR System Administrators and the Chief People Officer. Under Section 3.2, distribution of this appendix outside the HRIS requires written approval.

8. Termination & Exit Policy

Employment with Nexora is at-will except where local law provides otherwise. Either the employee or the Company may terminate the employment relationship at any time, with or without cause, subject to any applicable notice period required by local law or contract.

8.1 Voluntary Resignation

Employees are asked to provide a minimum of two (2) weeks' written notice of resignation. Exit interviews are conducted by a People & Culture Business Partner and are optional for the departing employee.

8.2 Involuntary Termination

Involuntary terminations require pre-approval from the employee's department head, a People & Culture Business Partner, and, for terminations related to policy violations, the Compliance Officer. Severance, where applicable, is calculated per the Severance Guidelines referenced in the companion Operational Guidelines document.

8.3 Return of Company Property and Access Revocation

On the employee's last working day, IT Security must revoke all system access — including VPN, email, and Restricted-data systems — within four (4) hours of the termination being recorded in the HRIS. All Company equipment, badges, and physical keys must be returned before the final paycheck is released.

— End of Employee Policy Handbook —